

Maggie and the little water pump

Cowboy story • 3-4 years old



Part One

Maggie rides out at dawn. She wears a hat and a warm smile. Her horse, Star, walks slow. The sky is pink. The prairie is wide. Birds sing. Maggie looks for the old water pump.

The ranch needs water. The calves need water. The flowers need water. Maggie loves the pump. She checks it every day. She loves to twist the handle and hear water splash. « **Hello, pump,** » she says. « **Hello, friends,** » says Star.

One morning the pump groans. The handle is stiff. Maggie pulls. The pump does not move. Maggie breathes slow. She is brave. She is smart. She remembers the toolbox. She ties her scarf, she ties Star, and she opens the box.

She finds a small wrench. She finds a bright rag. She talks to the pump. « **We can fix this,** » she says. She wipes the handle. She listens. She looks inside. She sees a little pebble. « **A pebble!** » she laughs. « **You are tiny.** » She uses the wrench. She is careful. She is gentle. She tries again.

Water splashes! Star snorts. Maggie claps. « **Good job,** » she says. The calves run. The ranch is happy.

Part Two

Later, a storm comes. Clouds roll like big soft blankets. Wind hums in the grass. Maggie watches. A tree branch falls near the fence. The pump rocks a little. Maggie holds Star and keeps calm. She checks the pump again. It is safe. The handle is tight. She ties the pump with a rope to the post for extra care.

Neighbors come by on their horses. « **Do you need help?** » they ask. Maggie smiles. « **Yes, please,** » she says. They lift the branch together. They set things right. They share biscuits and tea. « **Thank you,** » Maggie says. « **Thank you,** »

the neighbors say. They bow their hats. They show respect.

Sun comes back. The prairie sparkles. Maggie waters the flowers. She waters the calves. She waters Star. She rests by the pump and hums a tune. Night comes. Stars blink. Maggie tucks Star in the stable. She pats the pump with her hand.

« **Good night, pump,** » she whispers. « **Good night, friends.** » The ranch sleeps. Maggie did her job with courage, thought, and heart. She kept the water flowing. All is calm and safe on the wide, loving plains.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the girl in the story?

- Maggie
- Star
- The pump
- A calf

2) What does Maggie ride?

- Horse
- Bike
- Car
- Boat

3) What was stuck and needed fixing?

- Pump handle
- Star's saddle
- The tree branch
- The toolbox

4) Who came to help after the storm?

- Neighbors
- Birds
- Calves
- The moon

Correct answers:

1) Maggie 2) Horse 3) Pump handle 4) Neighbors

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Dawn: The time when the sky gets light and the sun is coming up.

Prairie: A wide, flat place with lots of grass and few trees.

Calves: Baby cows that are small and like to drink milk.

Biscuits: Small baked treats that are dry and you can eat with tea.

Tucks: To gently put something in a safe, snug place.

Hums: To sing a quiet sound with your mouth closed.

Rope: A thick string you can hold or tie things with.

Post: A strong stick set in the ground to hold or tie things.